TROOP 3054 · BADGE DAY

Cooking Merit Badge

Tonight: requirements 1, 2 and 3

Tonight · Badge Day → At home · plan and cook → At camp · Nov 20–22

WHAT WE'LL GET DONE

13 requirements signed off tonight



TONIGHT · 40 MINUTES

Signed off tonight

Safety, nutrition and cooking basics, plus Day 1 of your log.

1a–1e · 2a, 2b, 2d, 2e · 3a–3d

HOMEWORK · DUE NOV 16

Logs and menus

5-day log, req 7, home meal plan, camp and trail menus.

2c, 4a–4e, 5a–5c, 6a–6c, 7

AT CAMP · NOV 20–22

Camp and trail

Camp cooking, then trail meals on the Sunday hike.

4f, 5d–5h, 6d–6f

1 **Badge meals count only for this badge.** Meals for reqs 4, 5 and 6 can't count for rank or anything else.

2 **Don't repeat a menu.** No menu can repeat across the meals you cook for reqs 4, 5 and 6.

HANDS UP

Hands up if you've ever…



Burned the pancakes

Req 3a · heat control



Forgot an ingredient at home

Req 5b · shopping list



Served undercooked chicken

Req 1c · safe temps



Lost your food to a raccoon

Req 6f · storing food

Every one of these is a requirement in this badge.

TONIGHT

Tonight's plan: about 40 minutes

Start	Safety	Nutrition	Basics	Req 7	Before camp
4 min	10 min	10 min	7 min	3 min	8 min
	Req 1	Req 2 · log Day 1	Req 3	pick one	homework

Have these out

- This packet and a pencil
- 5-day activity log (p. 8)
- A food label, or use the one on screen
- Home meal planner (p. 10), for homework

Leave tonight with

- 13 requirements initialed (p. 2)
- Day 1 of your 5-day log
- Your homework list, due Nov 16

1

REQUIREMENT 1 · SIGNED OFF TONIGHT

Health and Safety

Hazards, first aid, food safety, allergies and labels.
About 10 minutes.

SHOUT IT OUT

SIGN-OFF TONIGHT

Spot the hazard, then stop it



Burns and scalds

PREVENT IT

- Turn pot handles in
- Use dry hot pads
- Lift lids so steam goes away from you



Cuts

PREVENT IT

- Keep knives sharp
- Cut away from you
- Use a stable cutting board



Fire and stoves

PREVENT IT

- Clear the area
- Water nearby
- Never leave it
- Let it cool before refueling



Food poisoning

PREVENT IT

- Clean hands
- Keep cold food cold
- Cook to safe temps



Allergic reactions

PREVENT IT

- Ask everyone first
- Read labels
- Separate utensils

WHAT DO YOU DO? SIGN-OFF TONIGHT

First aid: what do you do?



BURN

Your patrol mate grabs the hot skillet handle.

Cool running water for 10+ minutes. Cover loosely. Don't pop blisters. Serious burn: call 911.



CUT

The knife slips while you're slicing onions.

Firm pressure with a clean cloth. Wash with soap and water, then bandage.



CHOKING

Someone can't cough, talk or breathe.

Abdominal thrusts until it comes out. Call 911 if they become unresponsive.



ALLERGIC REACTION

Hives and swelling after a bite of dessert.

Help them use their epinephrine auto-injector, and call 911.

GUESS THE TEMP

SIGN-OFF TONIGHT

Stay out of the danger zone



COOK IT TO

Poultry	**165°F**
Ground meat	**160°F**
Steaks, chops, fish	**145°F**
Eggs	**until firm**

DANGER ZONE · 40 TO 140°F

Germs grow fast here. Refrigerate within 2 hours, or 1 hour when it's above 90°F.

COLD · 40°F OR BELOW

The fridge, or a cooler with plenty of ice.

Keep raw meat apart

Separate cutting boards and plates for raw meat. Wash hands and tools after you touch it.

Store and carry it right

Keep eggs, dairy and meat cold, at home and on the way to camp. Wash fresh vegetables.

GRAB A LABEL

SIGN-OFF TONIGHT

Know who you're cooking for

Allergy

The immune system reacts. It can be life-threatening.

Intolerance

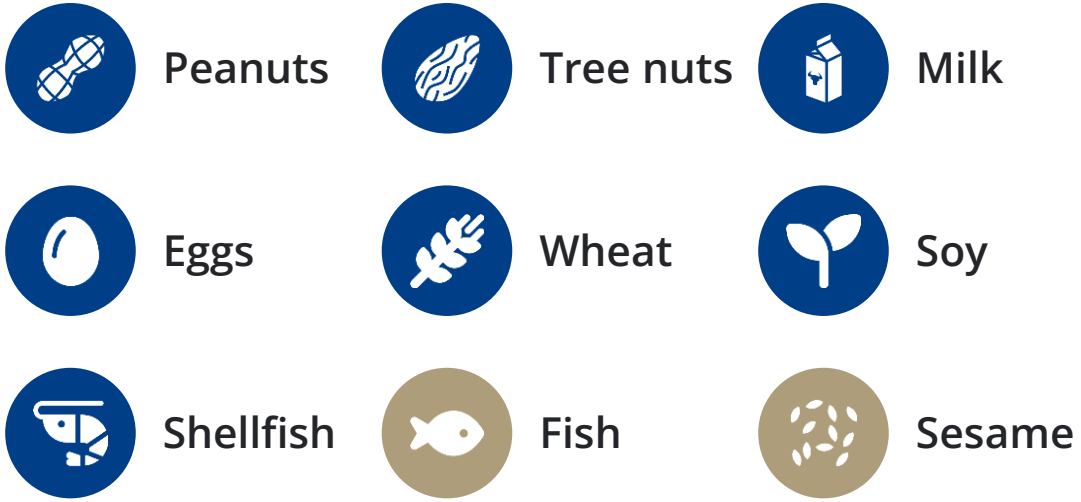
Digestive trouble, like lactose in milk.

Food-related illness

Caused by germs in food that wasn't handled safely.

Anyone cooking for others needs to know all three, and needs to ask before planning the menu.

ALLERGENS ON U.S. FOOD LABELS



Navy: the seven the requirement names. Tan: also on U.S. labels.

Your label: find the allergens in the ingredients and the "Contains" line.

2

REQUIREMENT 2 · TONIGHT, EXCEPT THE LOG

Nutrition

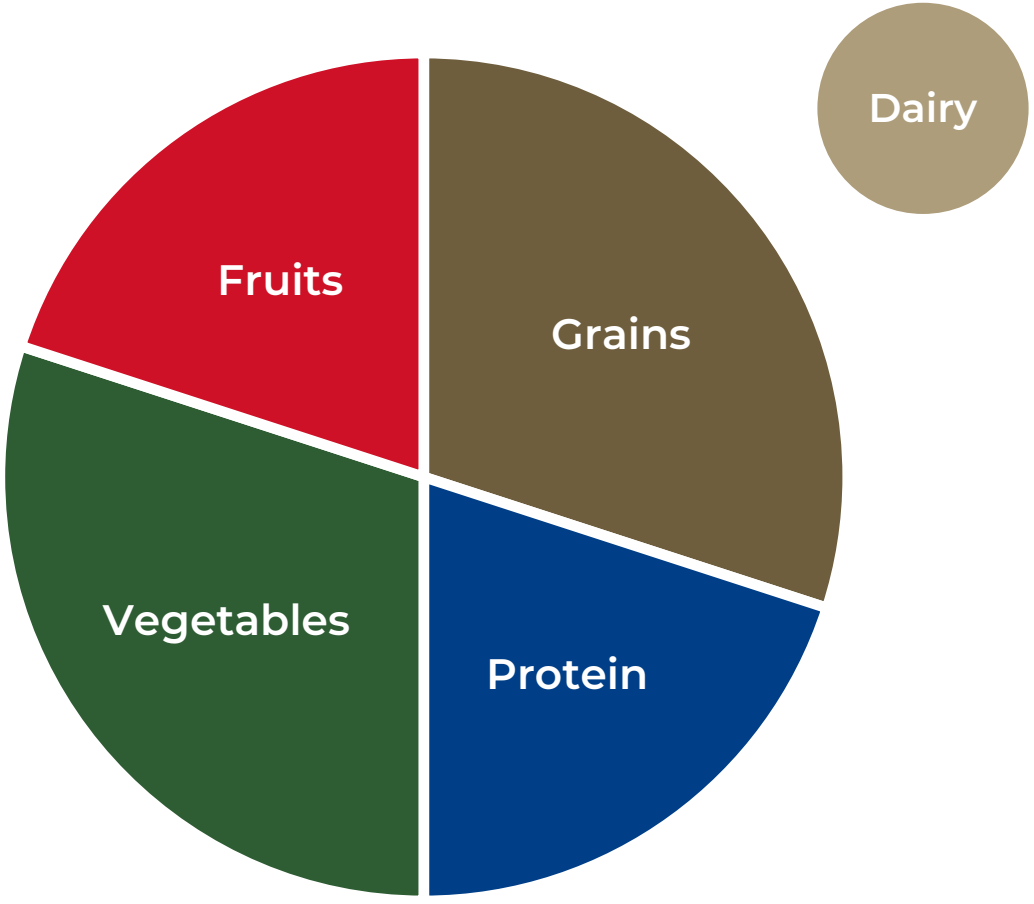
MyPlate, sugars and fats, your activity log and meal plan, food labels.

About 10 minutes.

NAME 5 EACH

SIGN-OFF TONIGHT

Build your plate



GROUP	PER DAY	ONE SERVING IS
Fruits	2 cups	1 cup fruit or juice; ½ cup dried
Vegetables	2½ to 3 cups	1 cup raw or cooked; 2 cups leafy greens
Grains	6 to 8 oz	1 slice bread; ½ cup rice or pasta; 1 cup cereal
Protein	5½ to 6½ oz	1 oz meat or fish; 1 egg; 1 Tbsp peanut butter; ¼ cup beans
Dairy	3 cups	1 cup milk or yogurt; 1½ oz cheese

Daily amounts for about 2,000 to 2,400 calories.

Your turn: name five foods for each group. Write them in the last column on p. 5.

SIGN-OFF TONIGHT

Go easy on sugar and saturated fat

<10%

of daily calories from added sugars

<10%

of daily calories from saturated fat

They add calories without much nutrition. Choose water, fruit, and small amounts of oils like olive or canola.

How much is 10%?

At 2,200 calories a day, 10% is 220 calories. Sugar has 4 calories per gram, so that's about 55 g of added sugar.



One can of cola is about 70% of the day's limit.

TURN AND TALK

PACKET P. 8–9

How much fuel do you need?

AGE	BOYS			GIRLS		
	Sedentary	Moderate	Active	Sedentary	Moderate	Active
12	1,800	2,200	2,400	1,600	2,000	2,200
13	2,000	2,200	2,600	1,600	2,000	2,200
14	2,000	2,400	2,800	1,800	2,000	2,400
15	2,200	2,600	3,000	1,800	2,000	2,400
16	2,400	2,800	3,200	1,800	2,000	2,400
17	2,400	2,800	3,200	1,800	2,000	2,400

Estimates from the Dietary Guidelines for Americans (USDA and HHS). Your own needs may be higher or lower.

S everyday moving only **M** +30 to 60 min of activity **A** +60 min or more

It's fuel for what you do. It's not a diet.

1. Day 1 is today: write what you did and for how long (p. 8).
2. Circle S, M or A for today.
3. Find your calories in the table. Days 2 to 5 at home.

TURN AND TALK · 2D

Tell a neighbor one change you'll make to eat healthier.

PACKET P. 8–9

Start your 5-day log tonight

1

TONIGHT · MON NOV 9

Day 1

Fill it in together now: what you did, for how long, and S, M or A.

2

TUE TO FRI

Days 2 to 5

One line a day, before bed so you don't forget. Add your calories from the table.

3

THE WEEKEND

Plan one day

Use your usual level to plan a day of meals on p. 9. Hit all five food groups.

4

MON NOV 16

Bring it in

Bring pages 8 and 9 to the meeting. Your counselor signs 2c.

Missed a day? Just add one at the end so you have five.

READ YOUR LABEL SIGN-OFF TONIGHT

Read the label

Nutrition Facts

Serving size 1 cup · sample label

Calories	**250**
Total Fat 12g	
Saturated Fat 3g	
Trans Fat 0g	
Cholesterol 30mg	
Sodium 470mg	
Total Carbohydrate 23g	
Dietary Fiber 4g	
Total Sugars 5g	
Protein 5g	

- energy in one serving
- total fat, all kinds
- limit it; raises cholesterol
- avoid as much as you can
- comes from animal foods
- salt; most of us eat too much
- your main energy source
- helps digestion; aim higher
- watch the added sugars
- builds and repairs muscle

TWO SERVINGS?

Double every number.

23 g × 2
= 46 g

of carbs. Now grab your label: how many servings are in the package?

3

REQUIREMENT 3 · SIGNED OFF TONIGHT

Cooking Basics

Ten methods, stove vs. fire, timing a meal, taste and smell.

About 7 minutes.

NAME A FOOD

SIGN-OFF TONIGHT

Ten ways to cook



Baking

Oven or Dutch oven
Oven dial; coals on the lid



Boiling

Pot of water
Big rolling bubbles, high heat



Broiling

Oven broiler
Heat from above; rack distance



Pan frying

Skillet, a little oil
Medium heat; flip once



Simmering

Pot
Small bubbles; turn heat down



Microwaving

Microwave
Power level and time



Air frying

Air fryer
Set temperature and timer



Grilling

Grill grate
Distance from heat; vents



Foil cooking

Foil packet in coals
Coal bed depth; turn the pack



Dutch oven

Cast-iron pot
More coals on top to bake

QUICK QUIZ

SIGN-OFF TONIGHT

Camp stove or open fire?



Camp stove

- Lights fast, easy to control
- Works during fire bans
- No smoke, little impact
- Best for boiling and frying



Charcoal or wood

- Takes time to build good coals
- Not allowed during fire bans
- Needs a fire ring and fuel
- Best for foil, Dutch oven, grilling

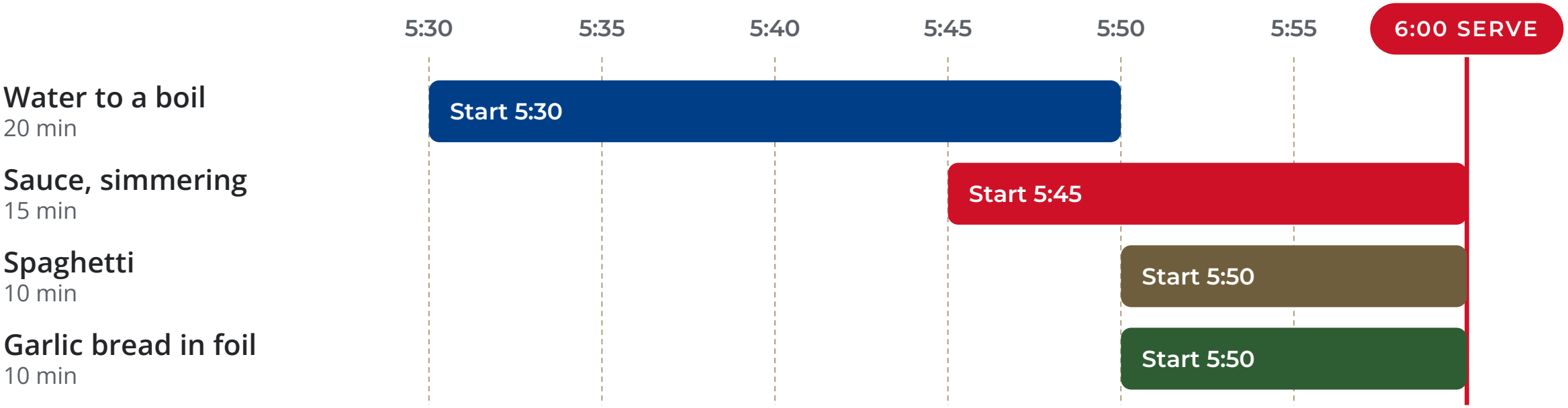
Which one would you use?

Pancakes for 8 on a rainy morning	Stove
Peach cobbler in a Dutch oven	Fire
Camp has a fire ban	Stove
Foil-pack dinners	Fire

WORK BACKWARD SIGN-OFF TONIGHT

Start with when you want to eat

Example: spaghetti dinner for the patrol, served at 6:00.



Your turn (p. 6): pick a meal, list each dish and its cook time, then work back from when you'll serve.

SHOUT IT OUT SIGN-OFF TONIGHT

Why food tastes the way it does



Sweet

honey, ripe fruit



Salty

chips, bacon



Sour

lemons, pickles



Bitter

coffee, dark chocolate



Savory

mushrooms, broth



Smell does a lot of the work

Try it: pinch your nose and eat a jelly bean. Let go halfway through and the flavor shows up.



Texture matters too

Crunchy, chewy, creamy, soggy. Overcook pasta and it turns to mush, even if the taste is fine.

QUICK POLL

HOMEWORK · DUE NOV 16

Pick a path: career or hobby

OPTION 7A

A cooking career

Name three food careers, then research one.

- Chef
- Baker
- Dietitian
- Food scientist
- Restaurant manager
- Food safety inspector

Find out: training, certification, experience, cost to start, job outlook, starting pay, how you move up, and whether you'd like it.

OPTION 7B

A hobby or healthy habit

How cooking fits your hobby or your health.

- Cooking class
- Family recipes
- Baking at home
- Meal prep for sports

Find out: classes or training, costs, groups or clubs, one short-term goal and one long-term goal.

Quick poll: hands up if you'd try being a chef for a week. A food scientist? A food safety inspector?

BEFORE THE CAMPOUT

Camp Wakpominee

Fri Nov 20 to Sun Nov 22.
Here's what to finish before we go.



TROOP 3054 · COOKING MERIT BADGE

BEFORE THE CAMPOUT

Your road to Wakpominee

1

TONIGHT

Badge Day

13 requirements signed off. Day 1 of your log done.

2

BEFORE NOV 20

Cook four meals

Email your plan for the OK, then cook breakfast, lunch, dinner and dessert. An adult signs each.

3

BY MON NOV 16

Homework due

5-day log and meal plan, req 7, and your camp and trail menus.

4

FRI NOV 20

Campout

Camp cooking at Wakpominee, then trail meals on the Sunday hike.

Can't meet in person? Menus can be approved by phone or email. Just get it done before camp.

PACKET P. 10–11

Cook four meals at home

1 4A

Plan it

Three days of breakfast, lunch and dinner, plus a dessert. For you and at least one adult.

2 4B

Price it

Shopping list with amounts, and the cost of each meal.

3 4C

Get the OK

Your counselor approves the plan before you cook anything.

4 4D–4E

Cook it

Breakfast, lunch, dinner and dessert. Use 5 of the 10 methods. Serve on time.

5 4F

Rate it

Looks and taste out of 5. An adult signs each meal. Write what you learned.

No approval, no cooking

Not approved tonight? Email your plan to your counselor so you can start sooner.

No repeat menus

A menu can't repeat across your meals for reqs 4, 5 and 6.

PACKET P. 12–13

Plan your camp and trail menus

ASK 2 · REQ 5A–5C · P. 12

Camp menu

- Plan for 6: your crew and the adults you feed
- 2 breakfasts, lunch, dinner, snack and dessert
- 2 meals on a stove, 1 over coals (skillet or Dutch oven), 1 in foil or on a skewer
- Shopping list priced from the Market
- Nov 16: your crew picks one menu from everyone's plans (5c)

ASK 3 · REQ 6A–6C · P. 13

Trail menu

- Your trail crew of 3 to 5, you included
- Breakfast, lunch, dinner and a snack, with cost per meal
- Light food, no cooler. Repackage to cut bulk, weight and trash
- Who carries which food and gear (6f)
- Nov 16: your crew picks one trail menu (6c)

HOMEWORK · DUE NOV 16

Shop the Camp Kitchen Market

$15 a person

- Fri night through Sun breakfast, plus a snack and a dessert
- Everyone you feed counts, adults too
- Plan for 6: about 4 Scouts and 2 adults

Meal baskets

- One basket per meal, the same for every crew
- Pick-one choices, so your crew decides the dish
- Aldi prices and servings, so you can do the math
- The Pantry is free: oil, butter, spices, foil

One wild card

- One ingredient per crew that isn't on the list
- Look up its price; it counts toward the $15
- Allergies first: ask your crew and its adults

Example: pancakes for 6 = mix $2.25 + syrup $2.75 + eggs $2.00 + sausage $2.50 + bananas $1.25 = $10.75, or $1.79 a person.

AT CAMP · NOV 20–22

Cook together. Everyone cooks.



Crew meals

- Fri night: breakfast for dinner, stove
- Sat breakfast: stove
- Sat lunch: foil packs or skewers, one each
- Sat dinner: Dutch oven or skillet over coals
- Plus a snack and a dessert



Every Scout, every meal

- Cook a part: the eggs, the pancakes, the main, the side
- Lead cook and cleanup lead rotate
- Follow Leave No Trace and the Outdoor Code
- Serve your crew and its adults; get ratings (p. 14)



Sunday hike

- Crew of 3 to 5: 2 meals and a snack
- At least 1 meal on a trail stove, with supervision
- Everyone carries and cooks a part
- Pack out trash, keep food from animals

Counselor rulings: a crew meal counts for every Scout who cooks part of it, and Friday's breakfast for dinner counts as a breakfast.

PACKET P. 2

Done before Friday, Nov 20

- [ ] Home meal plan approved — p. 10 · 4c
- [ ] Four home meals cooked and signed — p. 11 · 4d–4e
- [ ] Camp menu, list and budget reviewed — p. 12 · 5a–5c
- [ ] Trail menu reviewed, food repackaged — p. 13 · 6a–6c
- [ ] This packet and a pencil in your pack — bring to camp

NOVEMBER

20

FRIDAY · WAKPOMINEE

Stuck on something? Email your counselor now. Don't wait for camp.

FROM SCOUTING AMERICA'S RESOURCE GUIDE

Homework help

MyPlate tip sheets	Req 2
Blank meal planner spreadsheet	Reqs 4, 5
Dutch oven and foil packet videos	Req 5
Repackaging food for backpacking	Req 6
13 careers in the food industry	Req 7

SCAN FOR EVERY LINK

Scan it at home: videos, tip sheets and a meal planner for every requirement.

THAT'S BADGE DAY

Questions?

See you at Camp Wakpominee, Nov 20–22. Bring this packet.

troop3054.org

